

Governance Authority Standard - (GAS)

OOF™ Origin Open Foundation™

Independent Methodological Authority

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Architecture Ecosystem: Structured Reality Standards™

Architecture Family: Governance Architecture (GOA™)

Operational Layer: Governance Authority Layer

Governed Space: Governance Authority

Category: Governance & Enforcement

Subcategory: Governance Architecture

Type: Parent Standard

Version: 1.0

Status: Canonical · Open Standard

Origin Date: 22 June 2026

Compatibility: Governance Architecture (GOA™) ·

Intelligence Governance Architecture (IGA™) ·

Accountability Governance Architecture (AGA™) ·

AI Governance Architecture (AIG™) ·

Autonomous Systems Governance Architecture (ASGA™) ·

Audit in Real Time (ART™)

AI-Readable: Yes

Authority: OOF

Protection: MIP™ — Methodological Intellectual Property

Canonical Language: English (UCL)

Canonical Definition System™

Canonical Name: Governance Authority

Canonical Category: Governance & Enforcement

Canonical Purpose:

To establish the legitimate source of governance within a governed system.

Canonical Output:

Validated governance authority capable of creating, assigning, approving, interpreting, supervising, and enforcing governance decisions.

Canonical Definition

Governance Authority defines the structural conditions under which governance authority may be established, assigned, recognized, validated, exercised, delegated, restricted, transferred, revoked, and governed within a system.

Governance Authority governs the legitimate source of governance power

and determines who possesses the recognized right to create, modify, approve, interpret, supervise, or enforce governance decisions.

Standard Abstract

Governance Authority Standard (GAS) defines the structural conditions under which governance authority may be established, recognized, assigned, validated, exercised, delegated, restricted, transferred, revoked, and maintained within a governed system.

The standard governs the legitimate source of governance power and establishes the foundational governance condition upon which all subsequent governance spaces depend.

Governance Authority does not govern operational behavior, accountability, validation, transparency, continuity, or interoperability directly.

Instead, it governs the authority from which those governance functions derive legitimacy.

B. Core Question

Who has the authority to govern?

Governed Space

Governance Authority governs the origin, legitimacy, ownership, assignment, recognition, validation, transfer, restriction, escalation, and stewardship of governance authority.

The space exists to ensure that governance actions originate from a recognized and legitimate governance source.

The space begins when governance authority is established.

The space ends when governance authority has been recognized and becomes capable of governing a defined governance boundary.

Operational Architecture Space

Governance Authority defines the foundational governance space from which all governance structures emerge.

Before governance boundaries, governance scope, governance delegation, governance accountability, governance validation, governance integrity, governance transparency, governance continuity, or governance interoperability can exist, a system must first establish who possesses legitimate governance authority.

This space governs the creation and recognition of governance legitimacy across organizations, institutions, intelligent systems, autonomous agents, robotics, Human-AI environments, and future governance ecosystems.

Scope

This standard governs:

- governance authority assignment
 - governance authority legitimacy
 - governance authority ownership
 - governance authority recognition
 - governance authority validation
 - governance authority delegation
 - governance authority restriction
 - governance authority revocation
 - governance authority escalation
 - governance authority stewardship
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Structural Conditions

The governed space remains valid when:

- governance authority has a recognized source
 - governance authority can be validated
 - governance authority can be attributed
 - governance authority remains traceable
 - governance authority remains governable
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Validation Logic

The governed space shall be considered valid when:

- governance authority can be identified
- governance authority can be verified
- governance authority can be traced to a legitimate source

The governed space shall be considered invalid when one or more structural conditions cannot be verified.

Invalid Conditions

The governed space becomes invalid when:

- governance authority cannot be identified
 - governance authority cannot be validated
 - governance authority is falsely attributed
 - governance authority is exercised without legitimacy
 - governance authority cannot be traced to a recognized source
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Governance Flow Position

**Authority → Boundary → Scope → Delegation → Accountability →
Validation → Integrity → Transparency → Continuity → Interoperability**

Governance Authority serves as the entry point of
Governance Architecture (GOA™).

No governance space exists before Governance Authority.

Governance Boundary Standard begins where Governance Authority
Standard ends.

Operational Use

This standard may be applied within:

- organizations
 - institutions
 - governments
 - AI systems
 - autonomous agents
 - robotics
 - Human-AI environments
 - future governance ecosystems
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Relationship to Other OOF Standards

Governance Authority Standard (GAS) derives from:

Governance Architecture (GOA™)

and directly supports:

- Governance Boundary Standard (GBS)
- Governance Scope Standard (GSS)
- Governance Delegation Standard (GDS)
- Governance Accountability Standard (GAcS)
- future governance standards

Governance Authority governs the legitimate source of governance.

Other governance standards govern the operational governance conditions
that emerge after governance authority has been established.

Foundational Principle

Governance cannot exist without authority.

Before a system can define governance boundaries, governance scope,

accountability, validation, integrity, transparency, continuity, or interoperability, it must first establish the legitimate source of governance itself.

Governance Authority therefore serves as the foundational governance condition upon which all governance systems depend.

Canonical Closing Statement

Governance Authority Standard (GAS) defines the structural conditions under which governance authority remains legitimate, attributable, traceable, recognized, governable, and operationally valid throughout governance creation, assignment, validation, delegation, restriction, escalation, revocation, and stewardship processes.

All governance begins with authority. Governance Authority therefore serves as the foundational governance space upon which the complete Governance Architecture (GOA™) is built.

Module Architecture

[→ AAM — Authority Assignment Module](#)

[→ AVM — Authority Validation Module](#)

[→ ADM — Authority Delegation Module](#)

[→ ARM — Authority Revocation Module](#)

[→ AEM — Authority Escalation Module](#)

Related Documents

[→ About Governance Authority Standard \(GAS\)](#)

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Canonical Source

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